

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

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Dear Hiring Manager,

The Knowledge Paralegal role in A&O Shearman's Global Financial Markets group interests me because it sits at the intersection of legal research, knowledge management and finance work, and my background gives me a direct foundation for it.

My interest in financial markets work has a specific starting point. At A&O Shearman's open day in August 2026, I attended a private equity session and a finance workshop covering how different practice areas contribute to a transaction and the security structures lenders take, including examples involving aircraft and ship financing. That was the first time I saw how the legal mechanics of finance actually operate in practice, and it prompted me to follow up by completing a Coursera private equity course covering fund structures, leverage, value creation and exit strategies. I wanted to understand the commercial logic behind the legal work before seeking a role in it.

On the knowledge and research side, my LLM dissertation on GDPR development across jurisdictions required me to track how regulatory frameworks evolved in different legal systems and communicate findings clearly in writing, which is close to what knowledge work in a finance practice involves: monitoring legal developments, identifying what matters and making it accessible to practitioners. At BCLP's international arbitration team, I drafted procedural histories and conducted legal research under time pressure, becoming the only junior on the matter shortly before a significant submission deadline. Tracking outstanding actions and organising documents across that matter gave me a clear sense of how structured, reliable knowledge support affects a team's ability to meet deadlines.

I want to build that experience in a practice where the legal work itself is shaping market norms, and the GFM group's profile in innovative finance transactions is exactly that context. Working across practice groups and jurisdictions also reflects what I did at BCLP, where I coordinated with external translators and liaised with the client directly, so the cross-team nature of the role is something I have worked in before rather than something I am anticipating.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss the role further.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva